CampusFix: A Real-Time, Role-Based Campus Incident Reporting App Built with Flutter and Firebase

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GitHub repository: **https://github.com/mugishamoses/campusfix-incident-reporting-app** · Video demonstration: **[ADD LINK]**

***Abstract*—Broken facilities, water and power outages and safety hazards on campus are usually reported informally, so students cannot tell whether anyone acted and staff cannot prioritise. CampusFix is a Flutter mobile application backed by Firebase that lets verified students report incidents with a category, description, location and optional photo, and follow each report through a four-stage lifecycle (Submitted → In Review → In Progress → Resolved) in real time. Authorised staff triage a priority-sorted queue, change status with notes, set priority and hide abusive reports. The app uses a layered architecture (UI, logic, data) with Riverpod for state management, Cloud Firestore streams for live updates, and server-side security rules for role-based access control. Rules are verified with 11 emulator tests and the app with 14 unit and 4 widget tests.**

Index Terms*—*Flutter, Firebase, Cloud Firestore, Riverpod, role-based access control, incident reporting, mobile computing.

I. Introduction

Facility and safety problems on a residential campus—no water in a residence, a projector failing mid-lecture, an unlit gate—are typically reported through word of mouth, chat groups or e-mail. Reports get lost, duplicates pile up, and the reporter receives no feedback, which discourages future reporting. Staff, in turn, lack a single prioritised view of what is open.

CampusFix addresses this with three ideas: (1) a reporting flow that takes under thirty seconds, (2) a transparent status timeline that the reporter can watch update live, and (3) a staff workflow with priorities, notes and moderation, protected by server-enforced roles. Section II lists requirements, Sections III–VI describe the architecture, data model, state management and security, Section VII the UI/UX rationale, Section VIII testing, and Sections IX–X challenges and limitations.

II. Requirements

ID	Requirement	Implementation
F1	Campus-only registration, login, logout, persistent session	Firebase Auth (email/password); domain allow-list `@alustudent.com`; mandatory e-mail verification; `userChanges()` stream restores the session on launch
F2	Submit incident with category, description, location, optional photo	Six categories, validated form, campus location list, camera/gallery picker with on-device downscaling and upload progress
F3	Browse, search and filter reports	Live feed; status and category filters; free-text search over title, location and description
F4	Track status lifecycle	Four-step timeline built from a `history` sub-collection; in-app notifications on each change
F5	Staff-only administrative actions	Status, priority, resolution note, hide-as-spam—enforced in Firestore rules
N1	Real-time updates	Firestore snapshot streams → Riverpod `StreamProvider`s
N2	Privacy & anti-abuse	Anonymous reporting (name never stored), verified-email gate, five-open-reports limit, staff moderation
N3	Maintainability	Three-layer architecture, repository interfaces, 17 reusable widgets, lint-clean code

III. System Architecture

The app follows a three-layer architecture (Fig. 1). The **UI layer** contains screens and reusable widgets and never imports Firebase. The **logic layer** holds Riverpod providers and notifiers that combine streams, apply filters and run actions. The **data layer** defines repository interfaces (`AuthRepository`, `IncidentRepository`) with two

implementations each: a Firebase implementation and an in-memory fake used for tests and offline UI work. A compile-time flag (`FAKE_BACKEND`) selects the implementation; the rest of the app is unaware of which is in use.

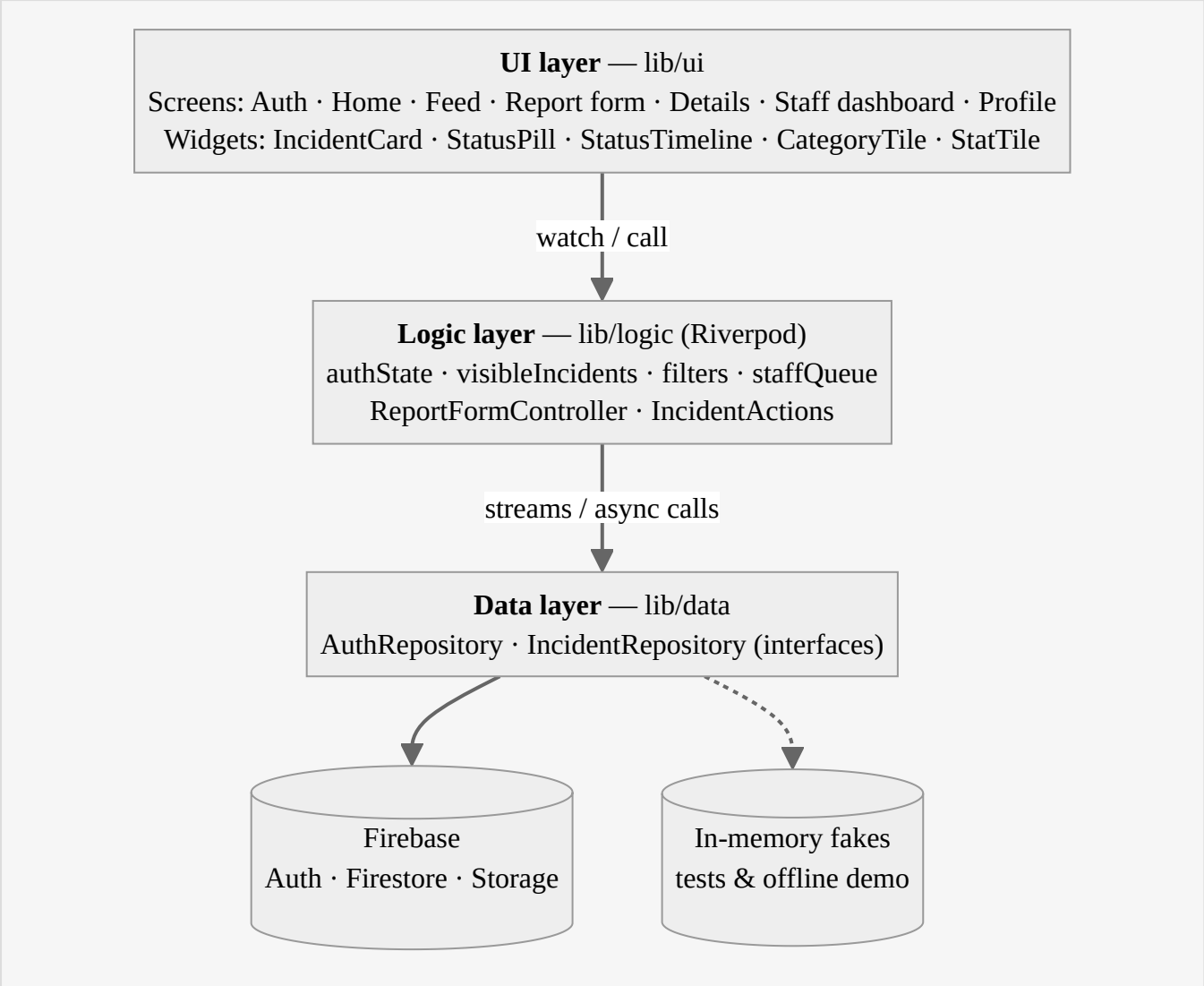


Fig. 1. Layered architecture. Only the data layer depends on Firebase.

Navigation uses `go_router` with a single `redirect` function that reads the auth stream: signed-out users are sent to login, unverified users to the verification screen, and staff are kept out of student-only routes. A `StatefulShellRoute` keeps each bottom-navigation tab's state alive.

IV. Data Model

Firestore is document-oriented, so the schema is shaped around the app's queries rather than normalised tables (Fig. 2). Status history is a sub-collection so the incident document stays small and the timeline can be streamed independently. Notifications live under each user so that a single owner-only rule protects them.

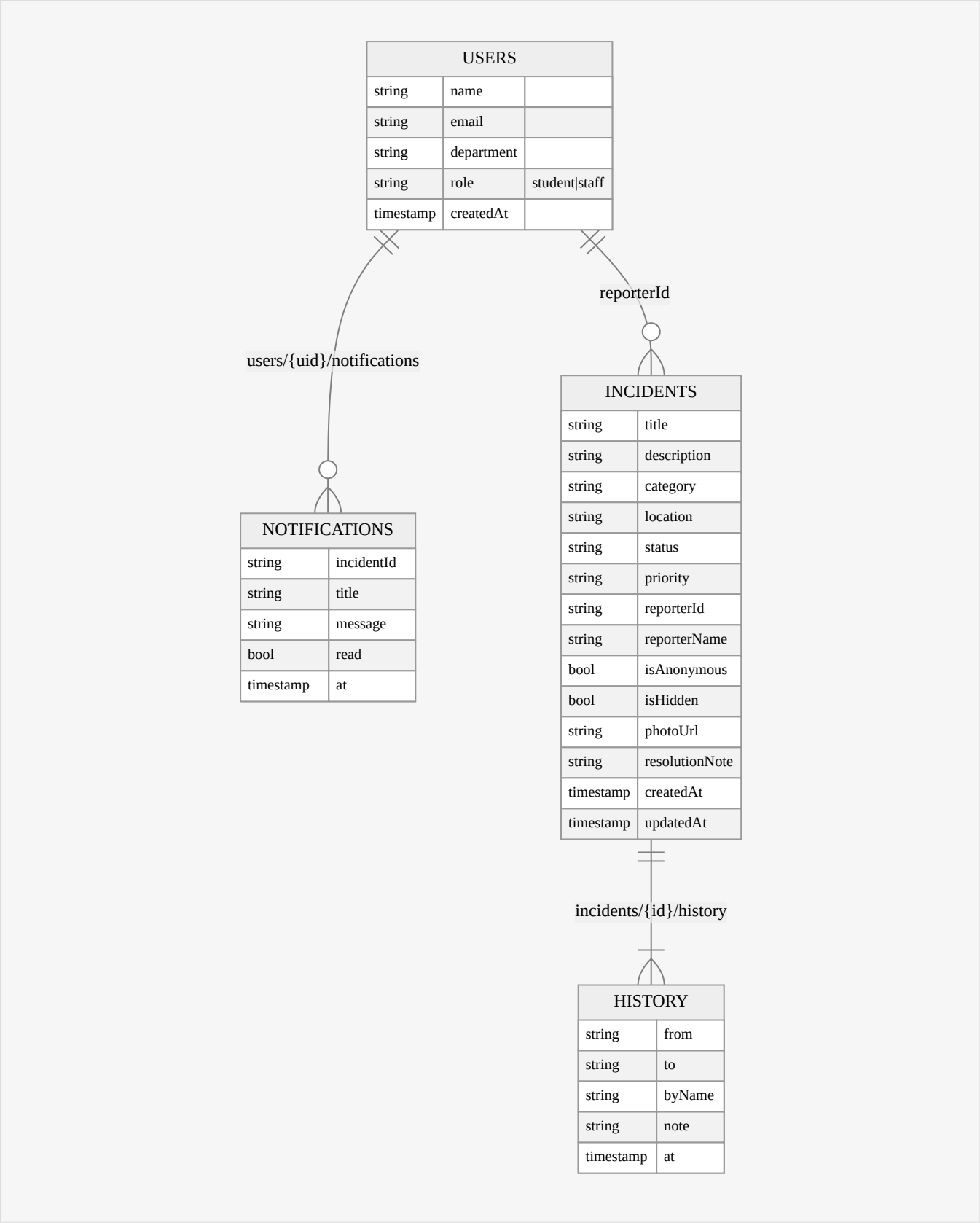


FIG. 2. FIRESTORE SCHEMA. PHOTOS ARE STORED IN CLOUD STORAGE AT `INCIDENTS/{UID}/{INCIDENTID}.JPG`.

Queries and indexes. All queries order by a single field (`createdAt`, `at`), which Firestore indexes automatically, so no composite indexes are required. Status/category filtering and search run on the client over the live list—an intentional trade-off for a campus-scale dataset (Section X).

Atomic writes. Creating a report writes the incident and its first history entry in one batch; a staff status change writes the incident update, a history entry and the reporter's notification in one batch, so the timeline and notifications can

never disagree with the status. Timestamps use `FieldValue.serverTimestamp()` to avoid device clock skew.

V. State Management

Riverpod was chosen over BLoC because Firestore already exposes streams: a `StreamProvider` wraps each stream, and derived `Providers` compose them declaratively (for example, `filteredFeedProvider = visibleIncidents ∘ feedFilter`). Every derived value recomputes automatically when any input changes, so a staff update propagates to the home stats, feed, profile list, details timeline and notification badge without manual wiring. `AsyncValue` gives every screen explicit loading, error and data states, rendered by one shared `AsyncSliverList` widget.

Mutable UI state lives in `Notifiers` (filters, report form, auth and incident actions). Widgets keep only ephemeral state such as text controllers and a password-visibility toggle; no application state uses `setState`. Streams are keyed on the signed-in user's id so they restart cleanly on account switch rather than erroring after sign-out.

```
// logic/incident_providers.dart (excerpt)
final filteredFeedProvider = Provider<AsyncValue<List<Incident>>>((ref) {
  final filter = ref.watch(feedFilterProvider);
  return ref.watch(visibleIncidentsProvider).whenData(filter.apply);
});
```

Asynchrony. Actions are `async` methods wrapped in `AsyncValue.guard`; the UI listens with `ref.listen` to show snackbars on failure. Firebase exceptions are translated to user-readable `AppFailure` messages in the data layer, both for one-off writes and on streams via `handleError`.

VI. Security and Role-Based Access Control

Client checks improve UX but cannot be trusted, so every rule that matters is enforced in `firestore.rules` and `storage.rules`. The role is stored in `users/{uid}.role`; self-registration can only create `student`, and a user can never modify their own role. Staff are promoted manually in the console by an administrator.

Actor	Allowed	Denied (examples)
Signed-out / unverified	Register (campus e-mail only)	Reading any report
Student	Read reports; create a report as themselves with status *submitted*; edit/delete own report while *submitted*; mark own notifications read	Spoofing reporterId; pre-setting status or isHidden; extra fields; changing status/priority; self-promotion
Staff	Change status, priority, isHidden, resolutionNote; write history and notifications	Rewriting a report's title or description
Storage	Owner uploads images < 5 MB to own folder	Non-images, large files, other users' folders

Table I. Access matrix enforced by security rules.

```
allow update: if isStaff()
  && changedOnly(['status','priority','isHidden','resolutionNote','updatedAt']);
function isStaff() { return verified() &&
  get(/databases/$(database)/documents/users/$(request.auth.uid)).data.role == 'staff'; }
```

Privacy. When a student reports anonymously the real name is never written to the document (the stored name is "Anonymous student"), so it cannot leak through a direct database read; ownership is still tracked by uid for editing and rate limiting.

VII. UI/UX Design Rationale

The interface follows the provided mockups: a single purple accent (#8B10F2) on a soft lavender-grey background, rounded 16 px cards and Plus Jakarta Sans. Status has a consistent colour language everywhere (amber Submitted, blue In Review, purple In Progress, green Resolved), so users read state at a glance. A raised centre "Report" button keeps

the primary action one tap away from every tab. The report form uses large category tiles instead of a dropdown because the category is the most important triage signal. Every list has loading skeletons, an empty state with a next action, and an error state with retry; destructive actions require confirmation; submission shows progress and a success sheet with "Track my report". Touch targets are at least 48 dp and interactive elements carry semantic labels.

[ADD ANNOTATED SCREENSHOTS: Login · Home · Report form · Details (student) · Details (staff panel) · Staff dashboard · Firebase console]

Fig. 3. Key screens.

VIII. Testing Strategy

Level	Tool	What is verified	Result
Static analysis	`flutter analyze` (flutter_lints)	Whole codebase	0 issues
Unit	flutter_test	Validators (domain allow-list), date formatting, filter and stats logic, hidden-report visibility, repository batch semantics, report controller (validation, anonymity, 5-report limit), staff-only status change	14 pass
Widget	flutter_test	Login validation and error snackbar; report form validation and error clearing	4 pass
Security rules	Firestore emulator + @firebase/rules-unit-testing	11 scenarios covering registration, self-promotion, read gating, create validation, workflow fields, owner edit window, staff batch, notifications	11 pass
Live end-to-end	REST against production project	Demo student signs in, reads 7 reports, is denied status change and self-promotion	Pass
Manual	Android device	Full student and staff flows, two-device real-time update	[ADD]

Table II. Test pyramid.

Because every repository has an in-memory fake behind the same interface, logic and widget tests run in milliseconds without network or emulator, while rule tests run against the real rules engine.

IX. Challenges

Lost validation errors. A widget test revealed that Title/Description errors disappeared after submit. The cause was an inline "Choose a category" message inserted *above* the fields inside a `ListView`: list children are matched by index, so the insertion shifted the fields and rebuilt their state. The fix keeps a fixed-size placeholder in that slot.

Stream race in fakes. `async*` generators subscribe to the underlying broadcast stream lazily, so an event emitted immediately after listening was dropped. Replacing them with `Stream.multi` subscribes synchronously.

Dependency mismatch. google_fonts 9 targets the new standalone `material_ui` package and its `TextTheme` type is incompatible with Flutter's; the project pins google_fonts 8.

Rules are not filters. Firestore rejects a list query if any matching document could be unreadable, so per-document visibility for hidden reports cannot be expressed as a read rule on a feed query; hiding is therefore a moderation flag applied in the logic layer (see Section X).

X. Limitations and Future Work

(1) Search and filtering run on the client, suitable for hundreds of reports; at larger scale a search service (e.g., Typesense) and paginated queries would be needed. (2) The five-open-reports limit is enforced in the app, because security rules cannot count documents; a Cloud Function could enforce it server-side. (3) Hidden reports are removed from student views but remain readable via direct API access. (4) Notifications are in-app only; push notifications via FCM would require a Cloud Function trigger. (5) Staff promotion is manual. (6) Photo upload requires the Firebase Blaze plan.

XI. Conclusion

CampusFix demonstrates that a small, well-layered Flutter codebase can deliver a real-time, role-secured reporting workflow. Repository interfaces made the app testable without a backend, Riverpod streams made live updates nearly free, and server-side rules ensure that the role model holds even against a modified client. The main lesson was that correctness bugs (the list-index and stream-race issues) were found by tests, not by inspection, which justified investing in tests early.

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